

Document 09 — HQ Design System & Visual Language

Product Name: HQ

Tagline: Your AI Headquarters

Version: 1.0

Purpose

The HQ Design System defines the visual identity, interaction patterns, and design principles used throughout the HQ platform.

It ensures every screen, component, animation, and future mobile application shares one consistent visual language.

This document serves as the foundation for all UI and UX decisions.

Design Philosophy

HQ is not another SaaS dashboard.

HQ is an Executive Headquarters.

Every visual element should communicate:

- Intelligence
- Confidence
- Precision
- Professionalism
- Innovation
- Trust

Users should feel like they are operating from the command center of an AI-powered organization.

Brand Personality

HQ is:

- Intelligent
- Executive
- Modern
- Calm
- Trustworthy
- Premium
- Collaborative

- Forward-thinking

HQ is never:

- Playful
- Cartoonish
- Overcrowded
- Flashy
- Noisy
- Confusing

Brand Identity

Logo

The HQ logo represents:

- Leadership
- Headquarters
- Collaboration
- Artificial Intelligence
- Business growth

The logo must remain simple, scalable, and recognizable in both light and dark themes.

Logo Usage

Approved versions:

- Full logo
- Icon only
- Monochrome
- Light theme
- Dark theme

Never:

- Stretch the logo
- Rotate the logo
- Add effects
- Change proportions
- Use unapproved colors

Color System

Primary Colors

Primary

- Executive Blue

Secondary

- Intelligence Purple

Accent

- Success Green

Support

- Warning Amber
- Error Red
- Information Cyan

Neutral Palette

- White
- Surface
- Background

- Border
- Gray Scale
- Black

The neutral palette should provide excellent readability in both themes.

Theme Support

HQ supports:

- Light Theme
- Dark Theme

All colors must be defined as design tokens to ensure consistency.

Typography

Primary Font

Modern sans-serif for interfaces.

Typography hierarchy:

- Display
- H1
- H2
- H3
- H4
- Body Large
- Body
- Caption
- Label

Typography should emphasize clarity and professionalism.

Spacing System

Use an 8-point spacing grid.

Spacing tokens include:

- XS
- SM
- MD
- LG
- XL

- XXL

Consistent spacing improves rhythm and readability.

Border Radius

Use a consistent radius scale:

- Small
- Medium
- Large
- Extra Large

Rounded corners should feel modern without becoming overly soft.

Shadows & Elevation

Three elevation levels:

- Surface
- Card
- Modal

Shadows should create depth while maintaining a clean executive appearance.

Iconography

Use a consistent icon library.

Icons should be:

- Minimal
- Clear
- Professional
- Easy to recognize

Avoid decorative icons.

Executive Avatars

Each executive has:

- Unique avatar
- Department color

- Status indicator
- Executive badge

Avatars should communicate professionalism and individuality while remaining visually consistent.

Department Colors

Every department receives a subtle identifying color.

Examples:

- Executive Leadership
- Marketing
- Creative
- Research
- Technology
- Finance
- Sales
- Operations
- Analytics
- Customer Success

These colors help users quickly identify executive responsibilities.

Cards

Standard card types:

- Executive Card
- Mission Card
- Analytics Card
- Asset Card
- Notification Card
- KPI Card

Cards should follow consistent padding, spacing, elevation, and typography.

Buttons

Button hierarchy:

- Primary
- Secondary
- Outline
- Ghost

- Danger
- Success

All buttons should have consistent hover, focus, loading, and disabled states.

Forms

Forms should include:

- Inline validation
- Helpful descriptions
- Error messages
- Success feedback
- Accessible labels

Complex forms should be divided into logical steps.

Data Visualization

Charts must prioritize clarity.

Supported visualizations:

- Line Charts
- Bar Charts
- Area Charts
- Pie Charts
- KPI Cards
- Progress Indicators

Analytics should support executive decision-making rather than decoration.

Mission Timeline

The mission timeline visually displays:

Mission Created



CEO Review



Chief of Staff Planning



Department Execution



Quality Review



Mission Delivered

Users should always understand where a mission is in its lifecycle.

AI Status Indicators

Standard states include:

- Idle
- Thinking
- Researching
- Planning
- Writing
- Designing

- Reviewing
- Waiting
- Completed
- Error

These indicators should be consistent across all executives.

Notifications

Notification types:

Information

Success

Warning

Error

Every notification should include:

Icon

Title

Description

Timestamp

Related Mission

Motion Language

Animation principles:

Purposeful

Fast

Smooth

Subtle

Animations should communicate progress, not distract.

Examples:

Executive activation

Mission creation

AI thinking

Success celebration

Dashboard transitions

Empty States

Every empty state should educate and encourage.

Example:

"No missions found."

↓

"Launch your first mission and let your Executive Board begin working."

Loading States

Replace generic spinners with contextual executive activity.

Examples:

CEO reviewing your request...

Research gathering market insights...

Creative developing concepts...

Marketing preparing campaign strategy...

This keeps users informed and engaged.

Accessibility Standards

HQ follows accessibility best practices:

WCAG AA compliance

Keyboard navigation

Screen reader compatibility

High contrast support

Focus indicators

Accessible color combinations

Reduced motion support

Accessibility is considered a core feature, not an enhancement.

Design Tokens

All visual values must be stored as reusable design tokens.

Examples:

Colors

Typography

Spacing

Border radius

Shadows

Animation durations

Breakpoints

Z-index layers

This ensures consistency across web and future mobile applications.

Design Principles

Every interface should feel:

Executive

Intelligent

Calm

Confident

Professional

Premium

Human-centered

Scalable

Conclusion

The HQ Design System is more than a collection of UI components.

It defines the visual language of the HQ platform and ensures every interaction reinforces the experience of operating an AI Headquarters.